

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 542

By Johnson

A RESOLUTION to honor and celebrate the seventy-fifth anniversary of the Franklin Rodeo.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we honor and congratulate those community events that have been sources of great civic pride and are celebrating historic milestones; and

WHEREAS, one such event is the Franklin Rodeo, for which cowboys and cowgirls, since 1949, have stampeded to Franklin each May to take part in what is proudly billed as one of the largest rodeos east of the Mississippi River; and

WHEREAS, for seventy-five years, the Franklin Rodeo has been presented by the Franklin Noon Rotary Club, which was chartered on January 13, 1948, with just fourteen members; today, the organization has over 160 active and honorary members, representing a diverse cross-section of business and community leaders; and

WHEREAS, searching for a fundraising project that would make a meaningful impact, the members of the Franklin Noon Rotary Club settled on a rodeo, which had been championed by Dr. Harry Guffee, John Fowlkes, Preston Fowlkes, and Bob Corley, with key contributions by Ed Moody, who managed the rodeo from the 1950s until 1984; and

WHEREAS, the first Franklin Rodeo was held on Saturday, May 6, 1949, complete with a parade that captured the spirit of the community, led by Governor Gordon Browning and joined by local Rotarians, visiting cowboys, Franklin High School and Columbia Military Academy bands, and approximately 1,000 4-H members and their families; and

WHEREAS, although the rodeo's early years were challenging, today, the Franklin Rodeo stands as a testament to the resilience and character of the Franklin Noon Rotary Club and the community it serves; and

WHEREAS, over the past seven decades, the Franklin Rodeo has generated millions of dollars to support a variety of community causes, including financial aid for scholarships to medical, dental, and nursing schools and public school needs such as band uniforms and library books; and

WHEREAS, with an annual attendance of over 19,000, the Franklin Rodeo has been officially sanctioned by the Professional Rodeo Cowboys Association since 2005; the event now spans three nights, takes place in an air-conditioned arena, and features nationally ranked contestants and top-tier bucking stock; and

WHEREAS, it is highly appropriate that we recognize the Franklin Rodeo and congratulate the event's organizers on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the Franklin Rodeo on the occasion of its seventy-fifth anniversary, extending our appreciation to all those involved with this event and offering our best wishes for much continued success in the years to come.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.